

Ariel O. Saracho
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Rochester
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Research Fields

Primary: International Trade; International Macroeconomics. **Secondary:** Firm Dynamics; Financial Frictions.

Education

University of Rochester, M.A. and Ph.D. in Economics Expected 2027
Dissertation committee: George Alessandria (advisor), Fernando Parro, Yan Bai.
National University of Tucuman, B.A. and M.A. in Economics 2022
Academic merit scholarship; B.A. completed in the 95th percentile of the 2020 cohort.

Research

Full abstracts and drafts are available at aosaracho.github.io or on request.

Inventories, Trade Credit, and Imported Inputs in Firm Dynamics

Job-market paper; with Jiri Havel; preliminary draft available on request; expected full draft Fall 2026

Finding: Using confidential Belgian monthly customs transactions by firm, six-digit HS product, and origin/destination country linked to firm balance sheets, we find that bank credit and trade credit are substitutes for financially constrained firms, and that importers rely more on bank credit relative to trade credit when suppliers are farther away.

Method/status: We develop a dynamic importer model in which trade credit is an intertemporal financing choice for imported-input purchases. My main contribution is the importer-finance framework.

From Fewer Workers to Fewer Exporters? Population Growth and Exporter Dynamics

Working paper; with Kazuma Inagaki; draft available on request; presented at ETSG 2025

Finding: Declining labor-force growth reduces firm entry, shifts activity toward larger incumbents, and raises exporter participation. In the calibrated model, a one percentage point decline in labor-force growth raises the exporter share by about 1.1 percentage points, but explains only a small share of the observed rise in U.S. exporter participation.

Method/status: Dynamic heterogeneous-firm trade model calibrated to BDS and Census of Manufactures moments, combined with state-level IV evidence using lagged birth rates and an accounting exercise for trade-cost changes.

Disclosed Supply-Chain Risk, Inventory Adjustment, and the Trade-Credit Channel

Work in progress; solo-authored project; preliminary draft expected Spring 2027

Finding: Supply-chain risk language predicts future inventory accumulation, especially raw-material buffers. Firm-level trade-credit language mainly describes contemporaneous receivables and payables, while leave-one-out industry trade-credit risk predicts firms' payables adjustment.

Method/status: I build supply-chain, trade-credit, and working-capital risk measures from 136,056 SEC filings for U.S. public firms, 2018–2024.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, ECON 204: Principles of Macroeconomics Fall 2026
Rochester Education Justice Initiative, Groveland Correctional Facility. Designing and teaching an undergraduate principles course in a correctional-education setting, adapting standard macroeconomic material for a nontraditional classroom.

Instructor, ECON 209: Intermediate Macroeconomics Summer 2026
University of Rochester. Sole instructor for 9 students; designed syllabus, lectures, data exercises, assignments, exams, grading rubrics, and course materials. Introduced selected international-macro applications.

Teaching Assistant, ECON 270 and ECON 209 2024–2025
University of Rochester. Led recitations and office hours, graded exams and problem sets, wrote solutions, and supported course design for International Macroeconomics and Intermediate Macroeconomics.

Policy, Statistics, and Applied Research Experience

Head of Economic Indicators 2021–2022
State Statistics Department, Tucuman Government

Managed an eight-person team of economists, consultants, and interns producing at least five official indicators: monthly consumer prices, exports statistics, labor statistics, economic-activity estimates, and construction/development statistics. Supervised confidential price and trade data analysis and monthly publication of the Tucuman CPI, a sensitive statistic used in contracts, judicial resolutions, public reporting, and policy analysis. Presented results to Statistical Office Director and Executive minister occasionally and developed nowcasting tools using trade, employment, electricity, survey, and price data.

Data Analyst 2019–2021
Construction Trade Association, Tucuman

Estimated a monthly construction price index for the main regional private construction-sector association, using provider-level input-price information to track construction costs and regional price dynamics.

Freelance Economic Researcher 2019–2022
Private investors

Produced private market-analysis studies for investors, including analysis of Spain's software labor market and export-potential assessments for Tucuman goods and services.

Additional Research Experience

Research Assistant

2024–2025

University of Rochester / NBER project; Supervisor: George Alessandria

Implemented, solved, and simulated a dynamic inventory model with multiple transportation choices for a project with George Alessandria and Kim Ruhl. The work studies how firm-level shipment alternatives affect inventory adjustment and the aggregate consequences of transportation choices.

Research Assistant

Summer 2025

University of Rochester; Supervisor: Rafael Guntin

Built and harmonized input-output data for “Do Crises Shape the Economic Structure?” with Rafael Guntin and Lucia Casal. Supported empirical analysis of how sudden-stop episodes reshape sectoral production structures across advanced and emerging markets.

Research Assistant

Spring 2023

University of Rochester; Supervisor: Matias Moretti

Supported research on idiosyncratic risk, geographic diversification, and concentration in U.S. banking for “Geographic Funding Risk and Market Power in Deposit Markets” by Matias Moretti, Juan Morelli, and Venky Venkateswaran.

Research and Teaching Assistant

2019–2021

Tucuman, Argentina; Supervisors: Maria Jose Granados and Victor Elias

Supported research and teaching in applied economics, international trade, and labor economics. Work included time-series analysis, ARIMA models, seasonal adjustment, cycle-trend filters, Ricardian and Heckscher-Ohlin models, Melitz-style exporter-firm models, and panel-data work on educational wage premia, training, human-capital investment, and unemployment outcomes using U.S. and Eurostat data.

Presentations, Grants, and Awards

Presentations: European Trade Study Group Conference, Milan; presented “From Fewer Workers to Fewer Exporters? Population Growth and Exporter Dynamics”

2025

Graduate Day, University of Rochester; presented research in progress

2024

Grants and fellowships: University of Rochester Ph.D. Scholarship/Funding Package

2022–2027

University of Rochester Economics Department Research Fellowship

Fall 2023; Summer 2024

Travel Grant, European Trade Study Group Conference, Milan

2025

Academic Merit Scholarship, National University of Tucuman

2020–2022

Award: Ever Better Graduate Mentor Recognition

2021

Publications and Reports

Saracho, Ariel O. “Synthetic Index of Business Cycle of Tucuman: State-Space Model Estimation.” ARESNOA, 2021.

Saracho, Ariel O. “New Equipment, Same Old Measures? Capital Composition in Development Accounting.” AAEP Working Papers, No. 4406, 2020.

Service and Leadership

Graduate Housing Coordinator, University of Rochester

2024–Present

Organize community-building events and resident engagement initiatives for Graduate and Family Housing.

Skills

Programming/statistical tools: Julia, Python, R, Stata/Mata, SQL, MATLAB, GAMS. **Software:** LaTeX, Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI, EViews, GRETSL. **Languages:** Spanish (native); English (C1; TOEFL 107).